

**Pre-examination Training for SC/ST/OBC Candidates under Regular
Recruitment Drive for Junior Associates**

English Language Set-1

Directions (1–6): Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Air pollution has long been recognised as a major environmental risk to health, but recent research is revealing that its impact goes far beyond coughing and breathlessness. A large European study tracking more than 300,000 adults over several years found that people living in areas with higher levels of fine particulate matter (PM2.5) had a significantly greater risk of dying prematurely from heart attacks and strokes. Another study, conducted in several Asian cities, showed that even short-term spikes in air pollution were associated with an increase in hospital admissions for respiratory infections among children and older adults.

What surprised many researchers was that these health risks remained substantial even after accounting for traditional factors such as smoking, obesity and lack of exercise. This indicates that polluted air is not just an additional burden on already unhealthy lifestyles, but an independent trigger for serious disease. It also suggests that merely improving personal habits may not fully offset the dangers of breathing polluted air day after day. In the same way, relying solely on masks and air purifiers may give a false sense of security if the overall air quality in a city remains poor.

Scientists have found that inhaled fine particles can enter deep into the lungs and even pass into the bloodstream. Once there, they may irritate blood vessels, making them narrower and stiffer. This can raise blood pressure and make it easier for fatty deposits to build up in the arteries. Over time, these changes can increase the chance of blood clots, which may then lead to heart attacks or strokes.

Normally, the body is able to repair minor damage caused by everyday exposures. But continuous contact with polluted air can lead to **chronic** inflammation in tissues and organs. This long-lasting inflammatory state has been linked with a wide range of illnesses, including diabetes, cognitive decline and certain types of cancer. Several studies have also observed that people living in highly polluted neighbourhoods often show higher levels of markers of inflammation in their blood, suggesting that their bodies are under constant internal stress.

Questions

Q.1. According to the passage, which of the following can connect the second and third paragraphs of the passage?

- A. The role of air purifiers in removing all harmful gases from the environment.
- B. The way polluted air directly affects the internal systems of the human body.
- C. The advantages of physical exercise in controlling air pollution.

- D. The comparison between smoking and air pollution as lifestyle choices.
- E. The reasons why some cities fail to measure air quality properly.

Q.2. According to the passage, which of the following statements is/are true?

- I. The European study followed more than 300,000 adults for several years.
 - II. Short-term increases in air pollution were linked with more hospital visits for respiratory problems.
 - III. Using masks and air purifiers completely removes the health risks of polluted air.
- A. Only I
 - B. Only II
 - C. Only I and II
 - D. Only II and III
 - E. All I, II and III

Q.3. Which of the following statements can be concluded from the third paragraph?

- I. Fine particles can contribute to the narrowing and stiffening of blood vessels.
 - II. Fine particles remain only in the lungs and do not enter the bloodstream.
 - III. The build-up of fatty deposits in arteries can be encouraged by polluted air.
- A. Only I
 - B. Only II
 - C. Only I and III
 - D. Only II and III
 - E. Only III

Q.4. According to the passage, which of the following is/are suggested by the fourth paragraph about chronic inflammation?

- I. It can be associated with diseases beyond heart attacks and strokes.
 - II. It may result from long-term exposure to polluted air.
 - III. It can always be completely reversed by short-term treatment.
- A. Only I
 - B. Only II
 - C. Only I and II
 - D. Only II and III
 - E. All I, II and III

Q.5. According to the passage, which of the following is implied about personal health measures such as exercise and the use of masks?

- A. They are unnecessary if air quality standards are high.
- B. They may not be sufficient to cancel out the harmful effects of polluted air.
- C. They are more important than improving city-wide air quality.

- D. They remove the need for governments to regulate emissions.
- E. They completely prevent chronic inflammation.

Q.6. Which of the following is the antonym of the word '**chronic**' as used in the passage?

- A. Gradual
- B. Temporary
- C. Constant
- D. Prolonged
- E. Persistent

Answer key

- **Q.1.** B. The way polluted air directly affects the internal systems of the human body.
- **Q.2.** C. Only I and II.
- **Q.3.** C. Only I and III.
- **Q.4.** C. Only I and II.
- **Q.5.** B. They may not be sufficient to cancel out the harmful effects of polluted air.
- **Q.6.** B. Temporary.

Directions (7-11): Read each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical or idiomatic error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer. If there is 'No error', the answer is (E). (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

Q.7. She enjoys **to read** (A)/ long novels, listening to music (B)/, and hiking (C)/ in the mountains. (D)/ No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q.8. Every one of the new employees (A)/ **are expected** (B)/ to attend the orientation (C)/ next week. (D)/ No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q.9. She is afraid (A)/ **from** heights (B)/ and avoids looking (C)/ down from tall buildings. (D)/ No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q.10. Despite of his young age, (A)/ he demonstrated a maturity (B)/ that impressed (C)/ everyone present. (D)/ No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Q.11. He is one of the most brilliant (A)/ minds **who has** (B)/ ever contributed to (C)/ the field of science. (D)/ No error (E)

- A. A
- B. B
- C. C
- D. D
- E. E

Answers Key:

Q.7. A (Error: "to read" should be "reading" to maintain parallelism with "listening" and "hiking" after "enjoys.")

Q.8. B (Error: "are expected" should be "is expected" because "Every one" is singular, requiring a singular verb.)

Q.9. B (Error: "from heights" should be "of heights." The correct idiom is "afraid of.")

Q.10. A (Error: "Despite of" is incorrect. It should be either "Despite" or "In spite of.")

Q.11. B (Error: "who has" should be "who have." The relative pronoun "who" refers to "minds," which is plural, thus requiring a plural verb.)

Directions (12-15): In each of the following questions given below there are three blanks, each blank indicates that something has been omitted. Choose the set of words for each blank which best fit to complete the sentence meaningfully.

Q.12. The rapid _____ of technology has profoundly _____ various aspects of daily life, leading to a _____ in how we communicate and work.

- A. evolution, influenced, revolution
- B. decline, distorted, regression
- C. stagnation, limited, setback
- D. acceleration, ignored, disruption
- E. deceleration, altered, preservation

Q.13. Many organizations are striving to _____ a culture of innovation by _____ employees to take calculated risks and _____ new ideas.

- A. foster, encouraging, explore
- B. suppress, compelling, reject
- C. discourage, allowing, ignore
- D. inhibit, forcing, dismiss
- E. establish, forbidding, conceal

Q.14. The ongoing climate _____ requires urgent global _____ to _____ the escalating environmental challenges.

- A. crisis, cooperation, address
- B. stability, disagreement, neglect

- C. improvement, isolation, worsen
- D. concern, resistance, overlook
- E. phenomenon, indifference, amplify

Q.15. Despite the economic _____, the company managed to _____ its market share and even _____ into new geographical regions.

- A. downturn, maintain, expand
- B. boom, lose, shrink
- C. stability, surrender, withdraw
- D. recovery, decrease, contract
- E. stagnation, reduce, consolidate

Answers:

Q.12. The rapid **evolution** of technology has profoundly **influenced** various aspects of daily life, leading to a **revolution** in how we communicate and work. **Correct Answer: A**

Q.13. Many organizations are striving to **foster** a culture of innovation by **encouraging** employees to take calculated risks and **explore** new ideas. **Correct Answer: A**

Q.14. The ongoing climate **crisis** requires urgent global **cooperation** to **address** the escalating environmental challenges. **Correct Answer: A**

Q.15. Despite the economic **downturn**, the company managed to **maintain** its market share and even **expand** into new geographical regions. **Correct Answer: A**

Directions (16 - 20) In the following question, a sentence is given with three words marked as (A), (B) and (C). Among the options choose the correct order of words that is required to make the sentence grammatically and contextually correct. If no change is required, mark 'No correction required' as the answer.

16. The government's **alleviate** (A) aim to **measures** (B) the financial **promote** (C) on low-income families and **burden** (D) economic stability.

- A. BADC
- B. CDBA
- C. DBAC
- D. ACBD
- E. No rearrangement required

17. The company announced plans to **operations** (A) its **expand** (B) globally, investing heavily in **technology** (C) markets and **new** (D).

- A. BACD
- B. DBCA
- C. ACBD
- D. BADC
- E. No rearrangement required

18. Despite the **adverse** (A) conditions, the team showed **weather** (B) determination and **victory** (C) a hard-fought **secured** (D).

- A. BADC
- B. DBCA
- C. ABDC
- D. ACDB
- E. No rearrangement required

19. The **challenges** (A) faced by the startup required **strategic** (B) solutions and an **approach** (C) to overcome **innovative** (D) them.

A. CADB

B. ADBC

C. DABC

D. BCDA

E. No rearrangement required

20. Experts believe that the new **research** (A) will **insights** (B) into the complex **provide** (C) of climate **dynamics** (D).

A. CADB

B. ADBC

C. BACD

D. ACBD

E. No rearrangement required

Answers:

16. A. BADC

Original Sentence: The government's **alleviate** (A) aim to **measures** (B) the financial **promote** (C) on low-income families and **burden** (D) economic stability.

Correct Sentence: The government's **measures** (B) aim to **alleviate** (A) the financial **burden** (D) on low-income families and **promote** (C) economic stability.

17. D. BADC

Original Sentence: The company announced plans to **operations** (A) its **expand** (B) globally, investing heavily in **technology** (C) markets and **new** (D).

Correct Sentence: The company announced plans to **expand** (B) its **operations** (A) globally, investing heavily in **new** (D) markets and **technology** (C).

18. A. BADC

Original Sentence: Despite the **adverse** (A) conditions, the team showed **weather** (B) determination and **victory** (C) a hard-fought **secured** (D).

Correct Sentence: Despite the **weather** (B) conditions, the team showed **adverse** (A) determination and **secured** (D) a hard-fought **victory** (C).

19. B. ADBC

Original Sentence: The **challenges** (A) faced by the startup required **strategic** (B) solutions and an **approach** (C) to overcome **innovative** (D) them.

Correct Sentence: The **challenges** (A) faced by the startup required **innovative** (D) solutions and a **strategic** (B) **approach** (C) to overcome them.

20. D. ACBD

Original Sentence: Experts believe that the new **research** (A) will **insights** (B) into the complex **provide** (C) of climate **dynamics** (D).

Correct Sentence: Experts believe that the new **research** (A) will **provide** (C) **insights** (B) into the complex **dynamics** (D) of climate.

Directions(21-25): Rearrange the following six sentences (A), (B), (C), (D), (E) and (F) in a proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph. Then answer the questions given below.

A) On Friday, three Myanmar nationals with serious bullet wounds were admitted to a hospital.

B) They were given shelter by the residents of Moreh, an Indian border town, who took them to a hospital.

C) The security crackdown in Myanmar following its February 1 military coup has sent people fleeing across the border into India.

D) The 'confidential' letter provides that only in the case of grievous injuries may an exception be made on "humanitarian considerations".

E) India shares a 1,643-kilometre border with Myanmar and is home to thousands of refugees from Myanmar in different states.

F) According to the police, about a dozen people from Myanmar moved into Manipur on Thursday after firing by Myanmar forces.

21) Which of the following should be the SIXTH statement after rearrangement?

- A.A
- B.B
- C.C
- D.F
- E.E

22) Which of the following should be the FIFTH statement after rearrangement?

- A.A
- B.B
- C.C
- D.F
- E.E

23) Which of the following should be the FOURTH statement after rearrangement?

- A.A
- B.B
- C.C
- D.F
- E.E

24) Which of the following should be the THIRD statement after rearrangement?

- A.A
- B.B
- C.C
- D.D
- E.F

25) Which of the following should be the SECOND statement after rearrangement?

- A.A
- B.B
- C.C
- D.F
- E.E

Answer Key:

The correct order of the sentences is as follows

C) The security crackdown in Myanmar following its February 1 military coup has sent people fleeing across the border into India.

E) India shares a 1,643-kilometre border with Myanmar and is home to thousands of refugees from Myanmar in different states.

F) According to the police, about a dozen people from Myanmar moved into Manipur on Thursday after firing by Myanmar forces.

A) On Friday, three Myanmar nationals with serious bullet wounds were admitted to a hospital.

B) They were given shelter by the residents of Moreh, an Indian border town, who took them to a hospital.

D) The 'confidential' letter provides that only in the case of grievous injuries may an exception be made on "humanitarian considerations".

Directions (26-30) : In this question, a part of the sentence is made bold. Below are given alternatives to the bold part at (A), (B), (C) and (D) which may improve the sentence.

Choose the correct alternative. In case no replacement is needed, mark (E) as your answer.

26) To prepare for his role in The White Tiger, Adarsh Gourav **working in a food stall in Delhi.**

- A. works in a food stall
- B. worked at a food stall
- C. worked in a food stall
- D. worked on a food stall
- E. No correction required

27) He washed dishes and swept the floor for **12 hours a day for a daily wage of ₹100.**

- A. 12 hour a day
- B. 12 hours in a day
- C. 12 hours into a day
- D. 12 hourly in a day
- E. No correction required

28) In The White Tiger, Adarsh Gourav **plays an enterprised man of humble origins who uses his street-smarts and cunning to escape the vicious cycle of poverty.**

- A. play on an enterprised man
- B. playing an enterprised man
- C. plays an enterprised man
- D. played an enterprising man
- E. No correction required

29) To get into the skin of his character, Balram, **he works in an food stall** in Delhi at a daily wage of ₹100.

- A. he worked on a food stall
- B. he works at a food stall
- C. he worked at a food stall
- D. he works in a food stall
- E. No correction required

30) Earlier this month, Adarsh earned a BAFTA **nomination and the best leading** actor category for his performance in The White Tiger.

- A. nominee and best leading
- B. nominee and the best leading
- C. nomination, yet the best leading
- D. nomination and the best lead
- E. No correction required

Answer Keys:

26. B, 27. E, 28. D, 29. C, 30. C

Directions (31-35): Following questions have words given in bold each having five alternatives. Choose the word among the given options which has either most similar or most opposite meaning to the bold word.

31. MEEK

- A) Pejorative
- B) Assertive
- C) Behest
- D) Avid
- E) Ubiquity

32. PETRIFY

- A) Appall
- B) Unravel
- C) Reek
- D) Invoke
- E) Confiscate

33. FIGMENT

- A) Filth
- B) Fervour
- C) Altercation
- D) Incursion
- E) Delusion

34. INNOCUOUS

- A) Pronounce
- B) Importunate
- C) Obnoxious
- D) Juxtapose
- E) Affluent

35. PROSCRIBE

- A) Primitive
- B) Condemn
- C) Requite
- D) Circumvent
- E) Precept

Answer Key: 31. B, 32. A, 33. E, 34. C, 35. B

Directions (36-40): In the following passage there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. These numbers are printed below the passage and against each five words are suggested, one of which fits the blank appropriately. Find out the appropriate word in each case.

On October 2, 1983 the Grameen Bank Project **(36)** the Grameen Bank. We invited the Finance Minister to be the Chief Guest at our **(37)** ceremony. But when the Ministry came to **(38)** that the ceremony would take place in a remote district, they said it would not be an **(39)** place to launch a Bank and that the ceremony should be **(40)** in Dhaka so that all the top Government Officials could attend.

36.

- A) reorganised
- B) merged
- C) named
- D) converted
- E) became

37.

- A) opening
- B) closing
- C) dedicated
- D) inaugurate
- E) induction

38.

- A) reveal
- B) know

- C) aware
- D) inform
- E) acquaint

39.

- A) excellent
- B) available
- C) inauspicious
- D) appropriate
- E) obvious

40.

- A) invited
- B) assembled
- C) done
- D) shifted
- E) held

Answer Key: 36. B, 37. E, 38. B, 39. D, 40. E